

> Light Energy <

How light behaves

1

Light travels in straight lines

Light moves in straight lines, called rays, away from a light source.



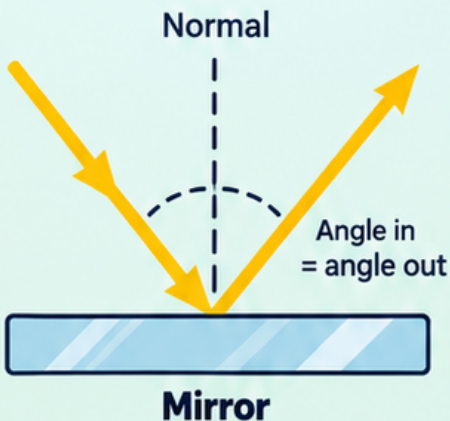
Sun

Light travels in straight lines.

2

Reflect

Light bounces off a surface. The angle of the incoming ray equals the angle of the outgoing ray.



Mirror

3

Refract

Light bends when it passes from one material to another (for example, from air into water).

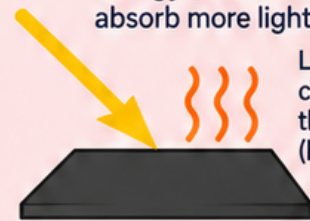


A straw looks bent because light changes speed in water.

4

Absorb

Some materials absorb light and convert it to thermal energy (heat). Dark colors absorb more light.

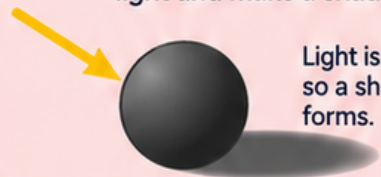


Light is converted to thermal energy (heat).

5

Block (Shadow)

Opaque objects do not let light pass through. They block light and make a shadow.



Light is blocked, so a shadow forms.



Light travels in straight lines until something reflects, bends, or blocks it.

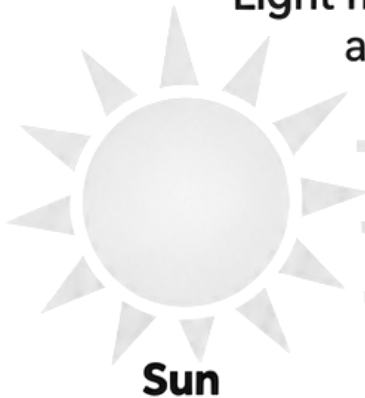
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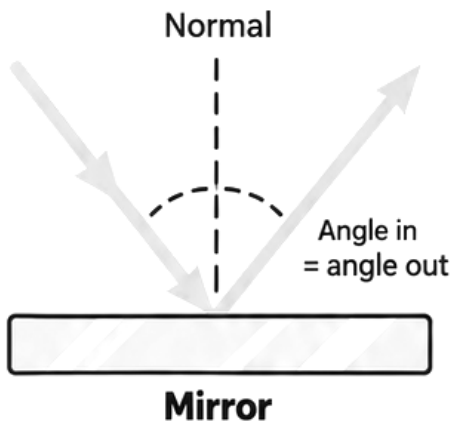
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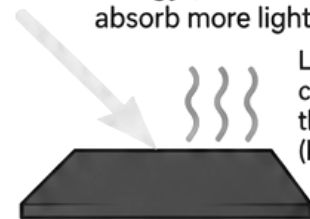


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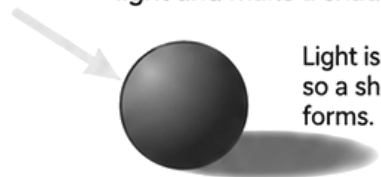


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